



Huawei Ascend W

Huawei showcased its first series of Windows 8 Phone with Ascend W1 and Ascend W2

Intel's WiDi 3.5

Intel launched its new version of Wireless display technology with support for Windows 8 and Touch Interface with 60ms latency on Ivy Bridge systems

Smartphone dilemma

I am a subscriber of Digit magazine. I need some help in buying a smartphone for my wife and me.

I am looking for something in the range of ₹10,000 to ₹15,000 for both of us. We both are new to smartphones, so I am expecting medium usage. If the range extends a bit by 1-2K, it shouldn't be a problem. I don't have any specific requirements about the OS, screen size, manufacturer, etc. We have zeroed in SE Ray ST18i, Sony Xperia U, Sony Xperia Pro, Sony Xperia Miro, Sony Xperia Tipo, Samsung Galaxy Ace Duos s6802, Samsung Galaxy Y s5360, Samsung Galaxy Y Duos Lite S5302, Micromax A87, Micromax Ninja A4, Micromax X650, Nokia Lumia 710. Please note that I don't prefer Blackberry and hence, my list doesn't include the same.

Rasesh B

A The shortlist that you have made is rather comprehensive! From that list, we would recommend the Sony Xperia U. The new NXT range of smartphones, which the Xperia U is a part of, is rather impressive. The Android ICS update has been rolled out, the build quality is much better than what you would expect in a phone in that price bracket and offers pretty stable performance as long as it is not loaded with a lot of apps. You have specified that yours will be a medium usage load on the phone, in which case the battery should last you a day and a bit more on a single charge.

Most of the other phones you have shortlisted are considerably less expensive than the Xperia U, but when you have the budget for this phone, anything in a slightly lower league will not be ideal.



Sony Xperia U

Which graphics card to get?

I want to buy a graphics card. Please give some suggestions in the budget of ₹13,000 - ₹15,000. I think that my PSU might not be sufficient for high end cards. Also

please suggest a good monitor, preferably 24 inch, good response time and around 15K. System Configuration:

- **Processor:** Intel Core i5-2500K
- **Motherboard:** ASUS P8Z68 V Pro
- **RAM:** 8 GB G-Skill Ripjaws
- **PSU:** Cooler Master GX 550 W (Bronze)
- **Cabinet:** Cooler Master 431 plus
- **CPU Cooler:** Cooler Master Evo 212

Please give some suggestions. Thanks

Ishan Katoch

A You can opt for NVIDIA GTX 560 Ti (for ₹12,000) which is a good value for money. Your PSU will easily support the GTX 560 Ti. As for the monitor we would suggest you go for BenQ GL2450H for around ₹12,000. That saves you ₹3,000 which you can invest in your graphics card budget to get the latest stock NVIDIA GTX 660 (for ₹17,000) which is a much better performer. (Just check out offerings from different vendors and opt for whichever gives a lower price)

Desktop or Laptop?

I have a desktop PC at home and I'm going to celebrate its 10th anniversary this month. It runs just about fine with Intel Pentium P4 single core 2.4 GHz processor, a 512 MB DDR RAM with 80 GB of hard disk running Windows XP.

I am pursuing Computer Engineering, I need to buy another PC to satisfy my needs. But I'm not sure about buying a laptop/ultrabook or upgrade my existing PC. I'm not an overclocker but want to play some games like NFS Hot Pursuit 2010, Mirror's Edge, etc., so I want a good GPU.

I need these features:

1. Nice CPU preferably 3rd gen Core i5 or i7 with at least 2.3 GHz
2. 4GB or more RAM
3. Optical drive is welcome though I have an external drive



ZOTAC GTX 560Ti

4. Good display preferably 15 inch with good resolution (no not Retina Display)
5. A good GPU
6. 320 GB to 750 GB HDD
7. Good connectivity options such as Bluetooth, Wi Fi and USB 3.0

My Budget is around ₹80,000 to ₹85,000. I also want to mention that what I want to buy is a desktop replacement, so I don't want to compromise on performance and it should be future proof, too.

Rutul Parikh

A Considering you are a student, it will be best if you invest in a desktop right now as you are looking at something which will last a long time. Ultrabooks are the lighter and more powerful counterparts of laptops. Right now ultrabook prices are quite high. Also they are best suited for professionals who have to access their system on the move. At the moment, for a student like you a desktop the best investment.

Here are the things you should invest your money in:

- **Processor:** Intel Core i5-2400 (₹11,200)
- **Motherboard:** MSI H67 MA-E35 (₹4,850)
- **RAM:** Gskill F3-12800CL9D-8GBXL (₹3,350)
- **GPU:** ZOTAC GTX 550Ti (₹7,450)
- **HDD:** Seagate Barracuda 2 TB (₹6,350)
- **PSU:** Corsair GS600 (₹4,000)
- **Monitor:** Samsung P2350 (₹10,800)
- **Optical Drive:** LG 22x DVD Writer (₹950)
- **Wireless Router:** TP-Link WR740N (₹1,100)
- **Total:** ₹50,050

On a side-note, if you are still not convinced of our desktop PC suggestion, you can check out Sony VAIO SVE1516EN (for around ₹44,000) and Toshiba Satellite CC850-X5212 (₹42,500). They fulfill all your requirements.